

Freight checklist for South African businesses

Use this before every shipment to get accurate quotes, avoid delays and protect your cargo.

1. Before you request a quote

- ☐ Collection and delivery addresses, with contact person and phone number
- ☐ Cargo description, total weight, and dimensions (L x W x H)
- ☐ Number of pallets or packages, and whether they can be stacked
- ☐ Required collection and delivery dates and any time windows
- ☐ Site access limits: gate height, loading dock, forklift availability, opening hours
- ☐ Special handling: fragile, high-value, temperature or hazardous goods
- ☐ Expected monthly volume, if you ship regularly

2. Packing and labelling

- ☐ Pack for road transport: secure, wrap and strap pallets so they cannot shift
- ☐ Label every package with the delivery address and contact number
- ☐ Mark fragile items and orientation clearly
- ☐ Photograph the cargo before it leaves your premises

3. Documents to prepare

- ☐ Delivery note or waybill with a full cargo description
- ☐ Tax invoice or packing list matching the goods
- ☐ Any permits or special documents your goods require
- ☐ Goods-in-transit insurance details (confirm what your carrier's cover includes)

4. On collection day

- ☐ Have the cargo ready, accessible and a person present to sign over
- ☐ Check pallet counts against the waybill before the driver leaves
- ☐ Note any damage or discrepancies on the waybill at collection
- ☐ Keep your copy of the signed waybill

5. On delivery

- ☐ Make sure someone is available to receive the goods during the agreed window
- ☐ Inspect the cargo before signing and note any shortage or damage on the proof of delivery
- ☐ Keep the signed proof of delivery for your records

6. After delivery

- ☐ Report any damage or loss to your carrier promptly, in writing, with photos
- ☐ Check your contract and insurance terms for claim deadlines
- ☐ Review the invoice against your agreed quote

Need a price? Get an instant estimate on our website or send us your load details and we reply within one working day.